

Formulation & Case Mapping Workbook

A full adult workbook for mapping difficulties, patterns, strengths, and treatment direction.

Structured self-reflection for the early stages of understanding and planning therapeutic work.

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Reminder

These workbooks are for self-reflection, therapeutic practice, and continued work between sessions. They are not a substitute for professional care, diagnosis, or medical advice.

Form 1

Initial Situation Snapshot

A calm overview of life areas, current difficulties, strengths, and direction for next steps.

What this form is for

To create a clear picture of what is happening across routine, mood, relationships, work, and functioning.

How to use it

Fill it in at your own pace. The goal is clarity, not a perfect answer.

How clear does my current situation feel right now?

Before writing, rate from 0 (low) to 10 (very strong):

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
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Home, routine, and functioning

What is the general state of my routine recently?

What is working relatively well right now?

Where do I feel stuck or overloaded?

Emotional state

Which emotions have appeared often lately?

When do these emotions get stronger?

What helps them soften even slightly?

Relationships and support

With whom do I feel relatively safe?

Where is there distance, tension, or difficulty?

What kind of support would be useful?

Gentle summary

One thing I understand a little better:

One small practical step for this week:

A topic I may want to explore in therapy:

Practice suggestion

Choose one life area and write one small step that would make it 5 percent clearer or easier.

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Form 2

Thoughts, Emotions, and Behavior Map

A basic map of the link between an event, thought, emotion, body response, and action.

What this form is for

To notice the pattern that forms in a specific situation without judging it.

How to use it

Choose one recent event, preferably mild to moderate in intensity, and write briefly.

How strongly did this pattern affect me?

Before writing, rate from 0 (low) to 10 (very strong):

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
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The event

What happened?

Where did it happen and who was there?

What detail stood out to me?

Thoughts

What went through my mind?

What was the strongest thought?

How much did I believe it at the time?

Emotion and body

Which emotions came up?

What did I notice in my body?

What did the emotion seem to push me to do?

Next step

What response did I choose?

What was the result?

What would I like to try next time?

Practice suggestion

Use this map once this week after a situation that brought up an emotional reaction.

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Form 3

Identifying the Core Difficulty

A structured way to define the main problem, when it appears, and what may maintain it.

What this form is for

To reduce overwhelm by naming the difficulty in clear and specific language.

How to use it

Describe one main difficulty as concretely as possible. Avoid global labels like 'everything is wrong.'

How clearly can I name the main difficulty?

Before writing, rate from 0 (low) to 10 (very strong):

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Defining the difficulty

What is the main difficulty I am facing now?

How does it show up in daily life?

When does it happen most often?

Triggers and maintaining factors

What usually activates this difficulty?

What keeps it going?

What makes it worse?

Impact

How does it affect routine, work, family, or relationships?

What does it stop me from doing?

What matters most to understand?

Initial direction

If one small change were possible, what would it be?

What would make this difficulty slightly more manageable?

What should I explore next?

Practice suggestion

Write the difficulty in one sentence, then rewrite it in a slightly more specific sentence.

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Form 4

Strengths and Resources

A map of personal strengths, support sources, values, and previous successes.

What this form is for

To remember that the difficulty is not the whole story; skills, support, and values are also present.

How to use it

Think about places in life where you have coped, even partially. Small strengths count.

How connected do I feel to my strengths right now?

Before writing, rate from 0 (low) to 10 (very strong):

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Personal strengths

Which qualities or abilities do I notice in myself?

Which strength helps me when things are hard?

What do others sometimes appreciate in me?

Supportive people

Who can support me emotionally?

Who can help in practical ways?

What kind of support is easier for me to receive?

Previous successes

What small or large success can I look back on?

What helped me succeed then?

What does that say about me?

Meaning and resources

Which values matter to me?

What gives me a sense of meaning or connection?

What can I lean on going forward?

Practice suggestion

Choose one resource and use it once this week in a simple, realistic way.

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Form 5

Expectations for Therapy

A form for naming what matters in therapy and what helps the process feel safe and useful.

What this form is for

To support clear, respectful alignment between the person and the therapeutic process.

How to use it

You do not need to know everything in advance. Write what matters, worries you, or would feel helpful.

How clear are my expectations for therapy?

Before writing, rate from 0 (low) to 10 (very strong):

0

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8

9

10

Starting point

What brought me to seek help or therapy?

What would I like to happen in this process?

What feels most important right now?

Sense of safety

What helps me feel safe in the process?

What might make it hard to open up?

What pace feels right for me?

What matters in the process

What do I need from the therapist or process?

Do I prefer tools, reflection, support, challenge, or structure?

What should be handled with care?

Signs of progress

How will I know therapy is helping?

What might be a first small sign of movement?

What expectation do I want to name clearly?

Practice suggestion

Bring one answer from this form into a therapy session or personal reflection.

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Form 6

Hopes, Wishes, and Goals

Moving from a general wish to small, specific, realistic goals.

What this form is for

To translate hope and desire into a clearer direction that can be practiced and reviewed.

How to use it

Start with one small goal. You do not need a full plan right away.

How clear is my next small goal?

Before writing, rate from 0 (low) to 10 (very strong):

0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Desired change

What would I like to be different soon?

What feels most important to improve right now?

How would I notice that change in daily life?

First goal

What is the smallest specific goal I can define?

What makes it realistic?

What would count as trying, not succeeding perfectly?

Supports and obstacles

What could help me move toward this goal?

What might slow me down?

What support or reminder would help?

Tracking

What is the first step?

When will I try it?

How will I review progress?

Practice suggestion

Choose one goal and reduce it until it feels small enough to begin today.

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Form 7

How I See Myself

A gentle look at self-image, strengths, critical voices, and a more balanced view.

What this form is for

To explore how I perceive myself without attacking or diminishing myself.

How to use it

Answer honestly, and also try to include a fair and balanced view.

How balanced is my view of myself right now?

Before writing, rate from 0 (low) to 10 (very strong):

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
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Self-perception

When I think about myself, what words come first?

What do I appreciate about myself?

What do I tend to ignore or minimize?

Self-criticism

What do I criticize in myself?

What inner voice appears when I make a mistake?

How does that voice affect me?

Strengths I forget

Which qualities are present even when I struggle?

How might a kind person describe me?

What can I partly agree to receive?

Balanced view

A more balanced sentence about myself:

A compassionate sentence I am willing to try:

One way to treat myself more fairly this week:

Practice suggestion

Write one balanced sentence about yourself and read it once a day for a week.

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Form 8

Summary and Next Steps

Collecting insights, progress, and a clear direction for the next stage.

What this form is for

To pause, gather what has emerged, and identify realistic next steps.

How to use it

Use after several forms, at the end of a period, or before a therapy session.

How much clarity and direction do I feel right now?

Before writing, rate from 0 (low) to 10 (very strong):

0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
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Insights

What have I learned about myself?

What felt most meaningful?

What pattern is clearer now?

Progress and challenges

What small change has started to appear?

What still feels difficult?

What needs more attention?

What helped

Which tools, thoughts, or practices helped most?

What support helped?

What did not fit and may need adjustment?

Next steps

What do I want to keep working on?

What is the next step I choose?

What support will help me continue?

Practice suggestion

Choose one insight and one next step. Keep them visible this week.

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